

DTH services tested

We look at 6 popular DTH services, with HD and DVR functions and pit them against each other

Bazaar

The latest in technology, including mobile phones, graphics cards and more, tested and reviewed for you

Clicking



Digital cameras have become a part and parcel of our daily lives. We're testing some of the most popular ones available and helping you choose one

Michael Browne
michael.browne@thinkdigit.com

Whether you plan a vacation, or are just looking to get into photography there's a lot a camera can do for you. At this point, we're probably sounding like the typical Croma salesman at the camera counter, and believe it or not, not all of us have come from the pedigree of film cameras, where composition and settings needed learning before clicking a shot. No, some of us were newbies to the world of still image capturing before working at Digit. But after seeing what a camera can do as a creator of memories, or as a hobby or even professionally, we're strong advocates of buying one.

If the evangelism of the previous paragraph elicited "meh" or "bah", let's get into it straight away. Before upping and buying a digital camera, you need to figure out what you need. There's no sense in buying an ultra zoom camera when all you want to do is take photos of your loved ones, conversely, an ultra compact would not help if you intend to shoot birds err the winged ones at least. Therefore, there's a camera for every need. Nowadays we're also seeing a lot of growing interest in dSLR cameras, and while we're not testing those hereunder it's important to note that a dSLR is a natural progression from a compact camera, once the user has pretty much mastered the basics of photography and wants to introduce more control to his

shots, with less interference from the cameras' AI system. Owing to the growing interest in dSLRs, we're also seeing the emergence of compact versions of these bulky beasts with detachable lenses, and larger sensors. While we didn't call for detachable lens cameras we still received two of them, the Olympus EPL-1 and the Sony NEX-5. We're testing them, but on account of their larger sensors, they put other cameras at a disadvantage. Even though the Sony NEX-5 was used as a benchmark, we haven't awarded any prizes to these two cameras.

CAMERAS UP TO ₹8,000: MINI CLICKERS

So you're one of those people who are upgrading from a cellphone camera and want something to click family photos and create

remembrances of that vacation you plan this year. There's a lot of camera that you can buy for 8,000 bucks these days, and while most of these clickers offer rather basic feature lists, it's better to spend today buying what you can afford now and start clicking, than to wait for that dream camera. A camera is a tool for you, no more and you're obviously looking for one that is idiot proof, with a rock solid auto mode, a decent zoom of around 4x, and 720p video recording would be a plus.

Features

The most basic clicker in the test managed to surprise us with a fairly decent feature set – the HP CB350 might not be able to give you a great image at ISO 400, but if you're not very discerning, it's hard to ignore decent performance at a price of ₹4,000 – we